

Final flourish: Calicut Heroes dominated the league, winning both the regular season and the Super 5s before defeating Delhi Toofans in the final.

SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



between playing in the league and representing India. Thankfully, those days are over.

Lifeline for Indian volleyball

The significance of the PVL is amplified by the current dysfunctional state of the VFI. With elections stalled and an ad hoc committee appointed by the Indian Olympic Committee at the helm, it became a lifeline for keeping volleyball alive in the country.

PVL's 48-match, 36-day third season culminated in a thrilling victory for the Calicut Heroes. The team, hailing from Kerala — India's volleyball hub — finally clinched the championship after two previous

Stormy presence: Delhi Toofans' Colombian middle-blocker Daniel Aponza attempting a smash. The Toofans' presence in the final validated the decision to expand the league. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



semifinal heartbreaks. Its success can be attributed to a formula: combining raw Indian talent with the strategic finesse of European technique.

The coaching duo of Kishore Kumar and Shailen Ramdoo was instrumental in crafting a championship team. Kumar, seeking to elevate his players' skills, brought on Ramdoo, his former FIVB coaching instructor. The results were undeniable — the Heroes dominated, winning nine out of 13 matches.

Leading the charge was Jerome Vinith, the team's captain and star player. Overlooked for the 2023 Asian Games despite consistent performances, Vinith delivered a match-winning performance in the final, earning both Player of the Match and Most Valuable Player of the Season awards. This victory was redemption for the 31-year-old.

"We (Indian players) are just turning professional with PVL, and we need to capitalise on this. The league is playing a crucial role in

Top players



Jerome Vinith — Calicut Heroes

Most Valuable Player, Top Scorer (161 points) & Top Attacker (150 points)

Daniel Aponza — Delhi Toofans

Top Blocker (26 blocks, 37 rebounds)

TR Sethu — Bengaluru Torpedoes

Top Server (23 points)

K. Anand — Delhi Toofans

Top Digger (77 digs)

Mohan Ukkrapandian — Calicut Heroes

Top Setter (123)

TR Sethu — Bengaluru Torpedoes

Top Receiver (89)